

Participant Information Sheet

Project title: Understanding Charts and Graphs: A Study on Data Visualisations

Chief Investigator: Dr Ananta Neelim

Associate Investigator: Professor Robert Hoffmann

Student Investigator: Saima Mehedi Khan

1. Introduction

Thank you for your interest in this project. This Participant Information Sheet explains the purpose of the study and what participation involves. Please read this information carefully before deciding whether you would like to take part.

Your participation in this study is entirely voluntary. If you decide not to participate, you do not need to provide a reason and there will be no disadvantage to you.

If you choose to participate, you will be asked to provide consent electronically before commencing the survey.

2. What is the purpose of this research study?

The research study is part of Saima's PhD project. The purpose of this study is examining how people engage with and understand data visualisations.

This study aims to investigate how university students interact with and comprehend different types of data visualisations, including bar charts, line graphs, and pie charts.

3. Who is organising and funding this research?

This study is funded by the University of Tasmania. There are no conflicts of interest to declare.

4. What does participation in this research involve?

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to complete an online questionnaire. The questionnaire contains items relating to data visualisations.

Participation is expected to take approximately 10 minutes.

5. Do I have to take part in this research project?

Your participation is entirely voluntary. Your decision whether to take part or not to take part, or to take part and then withdraw, will not affect your relationship with the University of Tasmania involved or the research team.

6. What are the possible benefits of taking part?

Participants will receive a standard participation fee through the recruitment platform. Additionally, participants will receive a \$1.75 bonus endowment as part of the study. Depending on their decisions during the study, they may keep some or all of this bonus.

7. What are the risks of taking part?

The risks associated with participation are considered minimal. The survey involves no sensitive questions and no physical activity. Participation may involve minor inconvenience or fatigue associated with completing survey questions. The research team will receive only de-identified survey responses and will not have access to identifying information held by the panel provider.

Approval to conduct this research has been provided by the Human Research Ethics Committee of the University of Tasmania. (Reference Number: H40658).

8. What if I withdraw from this research or modify my answers?

You may withdraw from the study at any time prior to submitting your survey responses by closing your browser window.

Because responses are collected anonymously and identifying information is not available to the research team, it may not be possible to withdraw your responses after submission.

You do not need to provide a reason for withdrawing, however, you will not be receiving the participation fee and the bonus if you withdraw.

9. How will the results of the study be published?

The findings from this study may be published in academic journals, conference presentations, reports, and other scholarly outputs. Only aggregated and de-identified results will be reported. No

participant will be identifiable in any publication or presentation arising from this project. Since we will not be collecting any personal information, anonymity will be guaranteed.

If you would like general information regarding the study findings, please feel free to contact the research team.

10. What will happen to the data collected from me for the research?

A UTAS-licensed online survey system, Qualtrics, will be used to collect your responses. Your responses will be temporarily stored on a secure Qualtrics server. Once data collection is completed, the data will be transferred to a password-protected UTAS computer and a secure UTAS approved Dropbox server, and deleted from the Qualtrics server within two weeks. Qualtrics maintains an offline backup system for disaster recovery purposes only, which is permanently deleted after 90 days.

Data collected will be anonymous and cannot be traced back to individual participants. It will be stored securely on UTAS-approved systems and will only be accessible to the research team. De-identified research data, analysis code, questionnaires and supporting materials may also be deposited in a journal-approved data repository as part of the publication process and shared in anonymous form for journal review.

11. What if I have questions about this research?

If you have any queries, concerns or issues with this research, please contact:

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Name: Dr Ananta Neelim
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12. Who has reviewed the research project?

This study has been approved by the University of Tasmania Human Research Ethics Committee. If you have concerns or complaints about the conduct of this study, you can contact the Executive

Officer of the HREC on (03) 6226 6254 or email human.ethics@utas.edu.au. The Executive Officer is the person nominated to receive complaints from research participants. You will need to quote H40658.